the way the private things—or a garbled version of them—become public. Things can sometimes get a bit confusing for everybody because of that. Brooklyn was out shopping with Victoria one afternoon. They were in a pharmacy and the lady behind the counter asked him:

'How's your mummy's new baby?'

Brooklyn must have taken to this woman because he happily told her he was getting a little sister named Paris. It took about 24 hours for that to turn up in the newspapers as fact: Brooklyn, aged three, had made the Beckham family's official announcement. It wasn't that we were trying to fool anybody: at that stage we didn't know whether the new baby was going to be a boy or girl ourselves. Anyway, just because the gossip columns and the bookmakers had got it wrong wasn't a reason for us to put their story right.

Husbands have it easy, don't they? The father-to-be just does what he can to help and looks forward to the new arrival. Before the day arrived, though, Victoria had to carry the new baby for nine months in her tummy. I love how Victoria looks when she's pregnant; I love knowing she's looking after something precious for us both; I love sharing all the ups and downs, the hopes and fears. But, for Mum, it must be hard in ways men can never really understand. I've seen for myself—twice now—how Victoria's emotions, her body, her hormones, everything, get turned upside down during pregnancy.

Romeo was born, like his brother, at the Portland Hospital in London. Some things were simpler because of the fact we'd been there before. I knew how to sneak into the Portland without being seen: we parked just round the corner from the hospital and I jumped into the boot of the car for the last few hundred yards' drive to the backdoor. But every baby's different and I can't imagine the whole thing would ever be routine. For Romeo, we had a last-minute panic when the doctor told Victoria he needed to do the caesarean the following morning, which meant me driving down from Manchester overnight to make sure I was there. And the day itself, of course, stands out clearly on its own: one I'll never forget.

You imagine beforehand that, once you've seen one baby come into the world, you'll be ready for the emotions when it happens again. But that's not how it was for me at all. When Romeo was first lifted up into the light in the operating room, the feelings of excitement and happiness, of pride and awe, just flooded through me with all the same intensity they had three years before, when Brooklyn was born. It was like it was happening for the first time all over again. It took my breath away how much I loved Victoria right